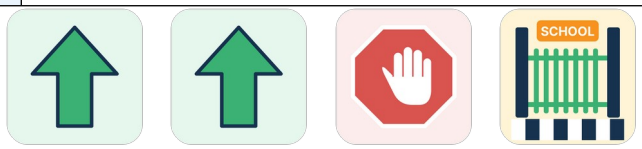
02 · Lesson spec

Following a Path · 40 minutes · whole class, then teams of 3 · fully unplugged · integration week

Goal	**I can plan 3 cards and guide Ayo along a straight path.**
Core parts	Move + Code
Key words	path · forward · stop · plan · follow
Materials	Forward and stop cards (plus walk and wave from earlier weeks); a straight taped path of 3–5 boxes per team; a box school gate with a zebra-crossing picture at the end; cardboard Ayo; a phone or tablet for the teacher to photo each card row



1. Watch (5 min)

- **Show** the taped path and the box school gate. **Say:** “Ayo must walk straight to the school gate. Robots can’t guess: we must **plan** all the cards **before** he moves.”
- Lay **forward, forward, stop**. Check them together: “First forward, next forward, last stop.” Then move cardboard Ayo one box per forward card.
- **Ask:** “What if one card is wrong?” Swap in a wrong card (forward, stop, forward) and run it: Ayo stops too soon! Fix it together.
- **Road safety:** “In real life we only cross the road at a zebra crossing, holding a grown-up’s hand.”
- **Hand signs:** forward = both hands push forward · stop = palm out · plan = tap your head, then point to the cards · path = trace a straight line in the air.

2. Do in teams of 3 (25 min)

a) Walk the line, whole class (7 min) · Core: Move

- Children walk the straight taped path like robots: **one step per forward card**, and **freeze** on stop. No turns.

b) Plan, run, fix, teams of 3 (13 min) · Core: Code

- Roles: **planner** lays 3 cards **before** anyone moves; **robot** moves cardboard Ayo (or walks) one box per card; **checker** says “first, next, last” and spots a wrong card.
- If Ayo does not stop at the gate, the team finds the wrong card and fixes it, then runs again. **Rotate roles** each time.
- Mix in walk and wave cards too, e.g. walk → wave → stop.
- The teacher takes a **photo of each team’s card row** (assessment evidence).
- **Stretch:** a longer path with 4–5 cards, or forward + ↻ cards.

c) Activity Book page (5 min)

- Trace Ayo’s straight path; circle the stop card. Not marked.

3. Share (10 min)

- Two teams show plan → run → fix for the class.
- **Ask:** “Why do we plan **before** Ayo moves? What happened when a card was wrong?”
- **Create** (if time allows): draw Ayo’s straight path to the school gate and the 3 cards he used.
- **Close:** “Plan, run, fix! That is how robot coders work.”

Common mistakes

- Moving Ayo while still laying cards → “Plan first! All cards down, then go.”
- Two steps for one forward card → “One card, one box.”
- Forgetting stop → Ayo walks past the gate; add stop at the end.

What if it doesn’t work?

- Teams are slow to plan → the teacher lays the first card; the team adds the rest.
- No tape → a row of paper sheets or chalk boxes; a chair can be the school gate.

Support and stretch

- **Support:** 2 boxes only (forward, stop); then 3 cards.
- **Stretch** (optional, never assessed): 4–5 cards or forward + ↻.

How we check

Observation only, plus a photo of the card row. Tick each child who **plans 3 cards before acting, runs them on a straight path and fixes a wrong card**.

> **Safety**
> The path stays inside the classroom; the gate is a box, not a real road. Walk, never run. In real life, cross only at a zebra crossing with a grown-up.